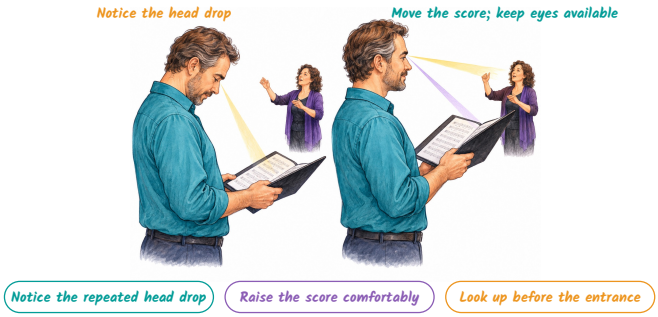
MODULE 01

Body Preparation & Posture

Find support, release extra effort, and see the cue.



Balanced Feet



Score at Eye Level

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

1. Balanced Feet
2. Shoulder Elevator
3. Jaw Rest Check
4. Seated Singer Setup
5. Score at Eye Level
6. Space Between Singers
7. Slow Body Scan
8. Hands Without Grip
9. Turn Toward the Cue
10. Posture Reset Signal

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 001

Balanced Feet

Body Preparation & Posture

3 minutes / Standing space or a firm chair.

Find a stable stance without locking the knees.



Feet comfortably apart

Knees easy, never locked

Weight supported, not gripping

Front and side views of a supported singing stance.

1

Place feet comfortably apart and soften the knees; seated singers rest both feet on a stable support.

2

Shift weight gently forward and back, then settle where neither heels nor toes grip.

3

Speak one short lyric line, then sing it on a comfortable note without changing the easy stance.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Feet remain quiet and the first sung phrase feels as easy as speaking.

COMMON TRAP

Locking the knees to look upright.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the whole activity seated; use small weight shifts instead of standing.

ACTIVITY 002

Shoulder Elevator

Body Preparation & Posture

3 minutes / No equipment.

Release unnecessary shoulder lifting before a phrase.

small lift

release



A small shoulder lift

Let the shoulders settle

Hum without another shrug

Lift a little, release, then keep the easy position.

1. *Lift both shoulders a small, comfortable amount and let them settle; repeat three times without rolling the neck.*
2. *Take an ordinary quiet breath while a partner observes whether the shoulders stay easy.*
3. *Sing a four-beat hum, rest, and repeat three times while keeping the shoulders settled.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers start the hum without a visible shoulder shrug.

COMMON TRAP

Rolling or forcing the neck while lifting the shoulders.

MAKE IT WORK

Observe your own shoulders in a mirror instead of working with a partner.

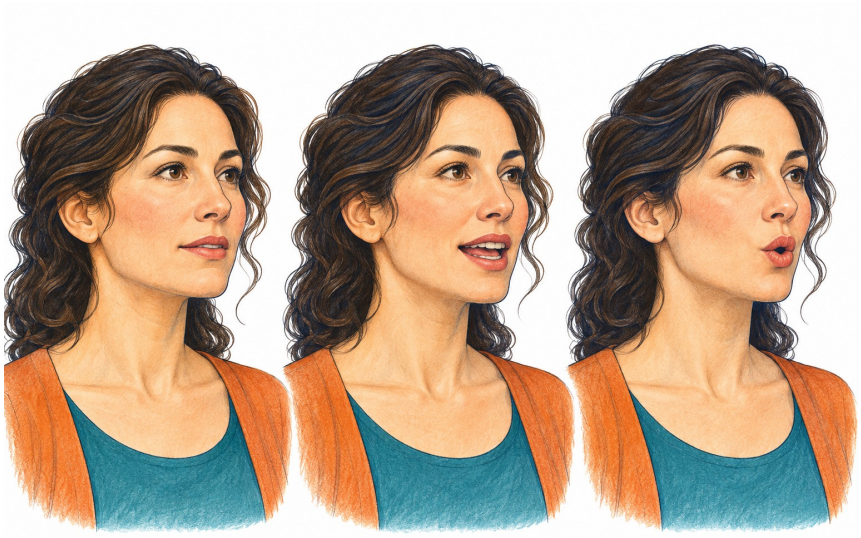
ACTIVITY 003

Jaw Rest Check

Body Preparation & Posture

3 minutes / A short familiar lyric.

Notice jaw clenching and return to an easy speaking position.



Unclench | Speak an easy "yeah" | Sing a small "oo"

Natural movement: no pulling, stretching, or forcing the jaw.

1. Let the lips part naturally, keeping teeth unclenched; do not pull the jaw open.
2. Say 'yeah, yeah, yeah' gently as in friendly conversation, then speak the lyric.
3. Sing the lyric on one comfortable note; pause and reset if the jaw begins to brace.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Words stay understandable without exaggerated mouth opening.

COMMON TRAP

Pulling the jaw open with the hands.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 'hello' instead of 'yeah'; no touching or jaw manipulation is needed.

ACTIVITY 004

Seated Singer Setup

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / Stable chairs without wheels.

Keep a useful singing position when standing is not practical.



Feet supported

Use a stable chair

See the director without craning

Comfort and a clear sightline matter more than a rigid pose.

1

Sit where the pelvis feels supported, with feet supported and room for the arms; do not force a rigid upright pose.

2

Look ahead at an imaginary director and breathe normally for two cycles.

3

Sing two short phrases, resting between them; adjust the chair or score height if the chin lifts.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Eyes can reach the director without craning the neck.

COMMON TRAP

Forcing every singer to sit at the front edge.

MAKE IT WORK

Use back support whenever needed; the goal is comfort, not sitting at the chair edge.

ACTIVITY 005

Score at Eye Level

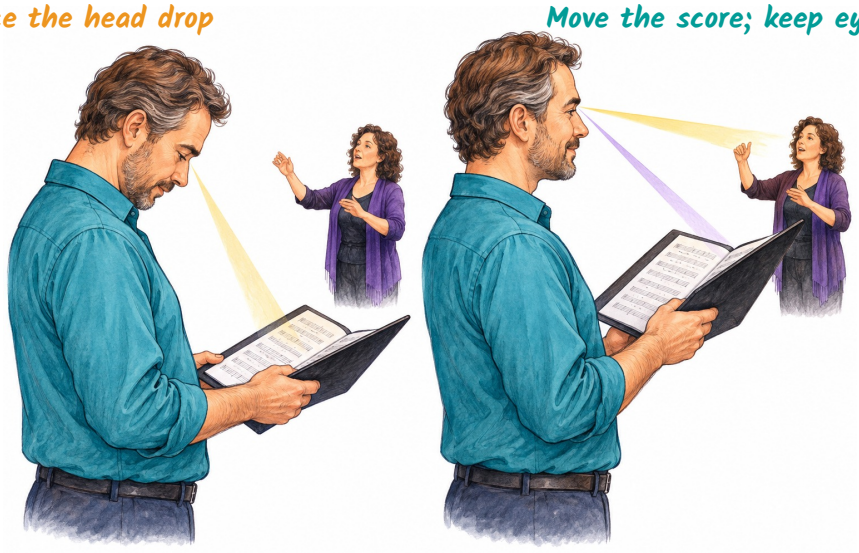
Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / A score or one lyric sheet.

Reduce repeated head dropping while reading music.

Notice the head drop

Move the score; keep eyes available



Notice the repeated head drop

Raise the score comfortably

Look up before the entrance

Move the score into a useful place; keep the elbows easy.

1. Hold the score so both music and director are visible; keep elbows comfortable.

2. Alternate looking at the first word and the director's hand for four silent cues.

3. Sing the opening phrase, looking up before the entrance rather than after it begins.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Most singers see the preparation gesture before making sound.

COMMON TRAP

Raising the chin instead of moving the score.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a music stand, large print, or a memorized line if holding paper is difficult.

ACTIVITY 006

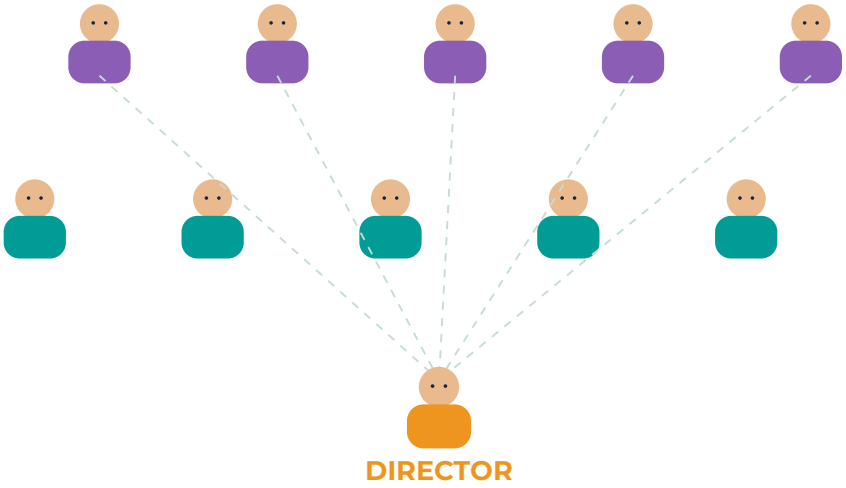
Space Between Singers

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / Rehearsal formation.

Create enough room for comfortable movement and sightlines.

Clear gaps through the front row



Stagger the back row so every singer can see the director.

1. Invite singers to check personal space without touching anyone; arms can remain by their sides.
2. Adjust rows so each singer sees the director through a clear gap.
3. Sing a short passage, then ask whether anyone is leaning around a neighbour; make one practical adjustment.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

No singer must lean or twist to see the beat.

COMMON TRAP

Creating neat rows that block someone's view.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep mobility aids in place and change the formation around access needs.

ACTIVITY 007

Slow Body Scan

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / Quiet rehearsal space.

Identify one unnecessary area of tension before singing.



Notice in this order. Change only what feels useful.

1. *Pause and notice feet, knees, shoulders, hands, and face in that order; change only what feels comfortable.*

2. *Uncurl fingers and release a clenched face while breathing normally.*

3. *Sing a gentle three-note pattern, then name one physical change that made the task easier.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers can name a specific helpful adjustment without being told to 'relax everything'.

COMMON TRAP

Trying to release every muscle at once.

MAKE IT WORK

Offer a silent observation option; no one needs to explain personal sensations to the group.

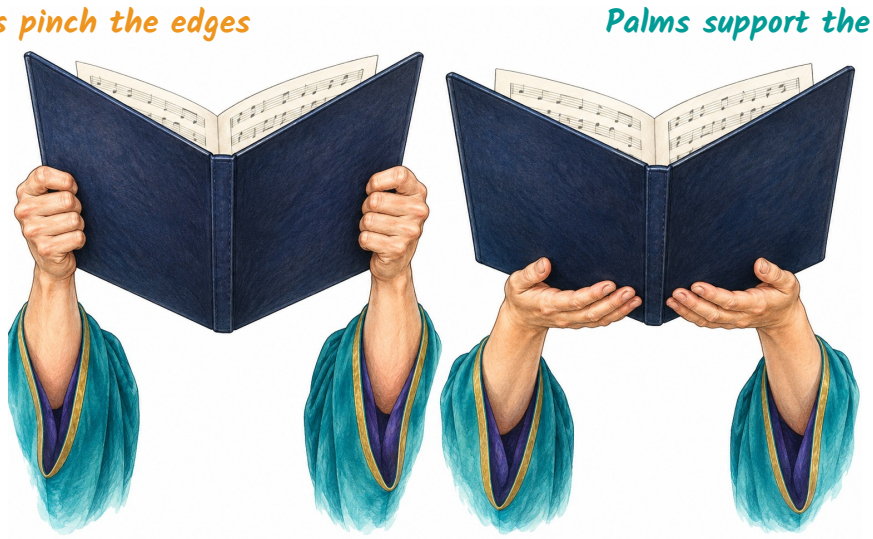
ACTIVITY 008

Hands Without Grip

Body Preparation & Posture

3 minutes / A light score or folder.

Stop score gripping from spreading effort into the upper body.



Notice fingertip pressure

Support the weight underneath

Keep the folder secure and light

A secure folder does not require a hard pinch.

1. Hold the folder normally, then briefly notice thumb and finger pressure.
2. Support its weight with the palms or a stand so the fingertips do less work.
3. Alternate two spoken lines and two sung lines while maintaining the lighter hold.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The folder stays secure without white knuckles or raised shoulders.

COMMON TRAP

Replacing a hard grip with an insecure hold.

MAKE IT WORK

Place materials on a stand or lap and follow from there.

ACTIVITY 009

Turn Toward the Cue

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / Two possible conductor positions.

Coordinate a small body turn without twisting the neck.



Find the main cue

Turn the body a little

Keep head and torso aligned

Let the whole body face the cue rather than twisting the neck.

1

Begin facing the main director and notice where the feet or chair point.

2

Move the whole body a little toward a side leader rather than turning only the head.

3

Follow four alternating silent cues, then repeat with a two-note sung response.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Eyes reach the cue comfortably with no prolonged neck twist.

COMMON TRAP

Turning only the head and holding the twist.

MAKE IT WORK

Seated singers can reposition the chair before starting or follow only the main director.

ACTIVITY 010

Posture Reset Signal

Body Preparation & Posture

4 minutes / One agreed open-hand signal.

Build a quick, nonverbal reset into a busy rehearsal.

OPEN PALM

Pause the phrase

RELEASE EFFORT

Find easy support

READY

Watch the next preparation



Agree the signal first; allow an ordinary breath before restarting.

1. Agree that an open palm means pause, release unnecessary effort, and find support.
2. Rehearse a short phrase; show the signal between repetitions and allow one ordinary breath.
3. Repeat the phrase and ask the choir to notice one improvement in readiness, not appearance.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group returns to readiness without a long verbal explanation.

COMMON TRAP

Using a reset signal before agreeing its meaning.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a spoken 'reset' alongside the gesture for singers who cannot see it clearly.